often has a meaning which varies with the standpoint adopted—does not scientific knowledge reduce to a plain relativism? Is there, then, no absolutely valid view, no absolute reality, independent of any special perspective?

It would be unfortunate indeed if this were so. No—there must exist, in science, too, absolutely correct and final maxims, just as there are absolute values in ethics. Moreover, and this is the main thing, these very propositions, maxims and values are the most important and worth while goals of every endeavor. In the realm of exact science, there are the values of the *absolute constants,* such as the elementary quantum of electricity, or the elementary quantum of action, and many others. These constants always prove to be the same, regardless of the method used for measuring them. The endeavor to discover them and to trace all physical and chemical processes back to them, is the very thing that may be called the ultimate goal of scientific research and study.

Nor is the situation different in the world of religion and ethics. To be sure, there, too, a considerable role is often played by the viewpoint that is adopted as a consequence of the special conditions involved in a given problem. Thus, the moral standard of truthfulness often appears to be loosened and weakened in a regrettable manner. I want to disregard here completely the conventional lies to which people resort for the sake of social amenities. But truthfulness, this noblest of all human virtues, is authoritative even here over a well-defined domain, within which its moral commandment acquires an absolute meaning, independent of all specific viewpoints. This is probity to one's own self, before one's own conscience. Under no circumstances can there be in this domain the slightest moral compromise, the slightest moral justification for the smallest deviation. He who violates this commandment, perhaps in the endeavor to gain some momentary worldly advantage, by deliberately and knowingly shutting his eyes to the proper evaluation of the true situation, like a spendthrift who thoughtlessly squanders away his wealth, and who must inevitably suffer, sooner or later, the grave consequences of his foolhardiness.

These absolute values in science and ethics are the ones whose pursuit constitutes the true task of every intellectually alert and active human being, a task which confronts all men again and again, in one form or another. This task is never finished—a fact guaranteed by the circumstance that genuine problems, even though sometimes accompanied by phantom problems, constantly appear in ceaseless variety and constantly set new tasks for active human beings. For it is work which is the favorable wind that makes the ship of human life sail the high seas, and as for the evaluation of the worth of this work, there is an infallible, time-honored measure, a phrase which pronounces the final, authoritative judgment for all times: *By their fruits ye shall know them!*